



Civic Meeting Report

Delaware County Council Meeting March 26th 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gsSSC1JlefQ
Publication Date	2024-03-26T15:17:15Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Comprehensive Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting Body: Delaware County Council

Meeting Date: March 26, 2024

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The transcript does not contain a statutory public hearing or committee session held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order. (Omitted per guidelines).

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the regular County Council meeting on March 26, 2024, at approximately **00:04:16**.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Webb, Mr. Blankinship (plankin), Mr. Mogle (M), Mr. Hughes, Mr. Whitehead (wad), Mr. Krantz (K), and Council President Ms. Piper.
 - **Members Absent:** None explicitly recorded as absent during roll call.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Ms. Piper (Council President).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Jane 00:04:20.
 - **Approval of the Agenda:** Approved by roll call vote following a motion and second 00:05:12.
 - **Approval of Prior Minutes:** Approved by roll call vote 00:06:07 following corrections noted regarding a ride-along thank-you to Sheriff's Office Corporal Wyatt (misstated previously as Corporal Ward) 00:05:46.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:06:21 County General Fund & Departmental Transfers (Backfilling)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Various department heads / Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council reviewed and processed a series of routine staff backfilling transfers (zero net change) across multiple county departments:
 - **Auditor (Fund 1000):** Settlement Deputy position adjustment (\$23,191.56) 00:06:24.
 - **Jail (Fund 145):** Correctional Officer position adjustment (\$3,320) 00:07:14.
 - **Communications (Fund 124):** Communication Tech position adjustment (\$30,692.34) 00:07:46.
 - **Assessor (Fund 134):** Chief Deputy position adjustment (\$27,772.18) 00:14:14.
 - **Commission (Fund 148):** Department restructuring and promotions moving environmental/planning positions (\$0 net change) 00:14:14.
 - **Recorder (Fund 128):** Chief Deputy position adjustment (\$3,829), featuring the introduction of Paula Morson as the new Chief Deputy Recorder 00:15:30.
 - **Sheriff (Fund 129):** Deputy position adjustment (\$40,677.30) 00:16:36.
 - **Circuit Court (Fund 138):** Assistant court reporter position adjustment (\$24,425.30) 00:17:11.
 - **Highway (Fund 117):** Certified welder position adjustment (\$37,675.76); noted difficulties in finding certified welders and plans to outreach to Ivy Tech 00:17:46.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Each transfer approved separately by unanimous roll call votes.
- **00:08:19 Public Defender's Office (Fund 139): Psychological Testing Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Shelley Harvey, Public Defender's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transferred \$2,000 from an investigator salary line to psychological testing, bringing an additional \$4,000 into the fund. Harvey explained that due to an ongoing investigator vacancy and revamp of job descriptions, staff

are acting as investigators while running short on defense-only psych evaluation funds. She noted that roughly 25% of reports return findings of incompetence to stand trial, resulting in intensive evaluation protocols and state facility placements. She warned the council she will likely need to request an additional \$20,000 later in the year.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by unanimous roll call vote 00:13:27.
- **00:19:08 Eligible Homestead (Fund 1216): Staff Position Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Auditor / Finance Committee.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of funds following an employee changing positions (\$26,655.38). Councilman Ryan Webb voiced strong procedural objections, noting this effectively functions as an in-season salary increase/restructuring outside of the September budget cycle and raises the chief deputy salary significantly above peers. Supporters countered that restructuring due to retirements warrants immediate action.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed by roll call vote (Mr. Webb voted No) 00:26:30.
- **00:19:08 Community Corrections Project Income (Fund 1122): Case Manager Salary Adjustment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jane Miranda, Community Corrections.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transferred \$5,000 to increase a case manager's salary to match peers in drug and veterans courts, aiming to retain certified staff. Councilman Webb objected to granting mid-year salary increases outside of budget season, while other members emphasized operational flexibility and staff retention.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed by roll call vote (Mr. Webb voted No) 00:35:31.
- **00:36:01 Community Corrections BC Grant (Fund 9220): Surveillance Supervisor Adjustment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jane Miranda, Community Corrections.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transferred \$4,000 from a vacant jail diversion coordinator position to home detention surveillance supervision to restructure and compensate an underpaid supervisor handling heavy home detention case loads. Grant funds must be fully utilized to avoid loss.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed by roll call vote (Mr. Webb voted No for consistency) 00:38:20.
- **00:38:49 Baron Expo Fairgrounds (Fund 4911): Appropriations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Donna.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$119,000 total, including \$10,000 for grandstand expenses (covering a new micro wrestling event and rising costs), \$6,000 for Eclipse 2024 advertising, port-a-potties, and security, and \$3,000 for Cobra-con (fireworks convention).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by unanimous roll call vote 00:11:14.
- **00:41:16 Ball Brothers High-Tech Crimes Unit (Fund 9214): Grant Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chuck Zimmer, Director / Council.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of remaining grant funds (\$12,749.69) for schooling, drying up the fund to zero.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by unanimous roll call vote [00:41:56](#).
- [00:42:02](#) **Eligible Standard Deduction (Fund 1216): Insurance Deputy / Secretarial Duties**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor / Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$2,655 to compensate an employee taking on commissioner and council secretarial duties following a retirement. Councilman Webb again objected to what he characterized as an in-season pay raise without standard budgetary protocol.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed by roll call vote (Mr. Webb, Mr. Whitehead, and Mr. Mogle/Finance members voted No; final tally passed via majority) [00:50:55](#).
- [00:51:09](#) **Motor Vehicle Highway Restricted (Fund 1173) & CCMG Matching Grant (Fund 9076): Paving Contracts**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tommy / Highway Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Fund 1173: Contractual services appropriation of \$250,962 for paving 350 North between State Road 67 and 400 East (2.25 miles). Lowest bid accepted from Brooks Construction (\$501,000 total project cost shared with match).
 - Fund 9076: Community Crossings Matching Grant (CCMG) appropriation of \$250,961.
 - Discussed high traffic and industrial truck volume (IMI concrete plant) necessitating contractor paving.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Both items approved separately by unanimous roll call votes [00:56:21](#), [00:57:05](#).
- [00:57:19](#) **Statewide 911 (Fund 1222): PSAP Equipment Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** 911 Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$155,000 for PSAP equipment (7 desktops, 2 laptops), establishing a formalized multi-year computer replacement rotation schedule.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by unanimous roll call vote [00:09:44](#).
- [00:49:45](#) **Surveyor's Corner Perpetuation (Fund 122): Professional Services Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Surveyor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$30,000 for professional land surveying services to locate, maintain, and record GPS coordinates for county cornerstones as mandated by Indiana code (5% per year). The fund has a healthy balance (~\$335,000) generated from recorder fees.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by unanimous roll call vote [01:03:23](#).
- [01:03:27](#) **Local Public Health Services (Fund 1161): Health First Indiana Allocation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jamie.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$50,763.10 resulting from redistributed funds from counties that did not opt into the Health First Indiana initiative. Jamie provided a comprehensive departmental update detailing staff increases from 12 to 17, creation of a community health division for social work/housing interventions, partnerships with the YMCA on swim safety, tattoo training pilot programs, planned TB and radon testing, and first floor renovation moves.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by unanimous roll call vote [01:16:45](#).
 - [01:16:45](#) **EDIT Projects (Fund 1112): Annual Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Auditor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual allocation of Economic Development Income Tax (EDIT) funds totaling \$5,482,296, primarily dedicated to debt service bond payments (including jail bonds of ~\$1.99M in June and December, and a smaller 2014 bond). Extensive discussion occurred regarding fund interest, bond terms, and the transparency of project lists.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Mr. Webb voted No) [01:27:32](#).
 - [01:28:10](#) **Resolution 2024-05: Economic Revitalization Area for Kaleidoscope Kids LLC**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John / Janelle (Owner, Kaleidoscope Kids LLC) / Redevelopment Commission.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Resolution declaring an area at North Wheeling and Hoffman Road an economic revitalization area (ERA) for a 5-year phased-in real estate tax abatement (~\$73,000 estimated savings) for a newly constructed \$3.6M child care facility.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Janelle explained that the project faced higher-than-expected construction and green infrastructure costs, serves low-income families via state vouchers (CCDC), and aims to fill a massive child care deficit for incoming corporate and medical professionals.
 - **Board Debate:** Council members debated the procedural timing (applying *after* building completion rather than as a pre-construction incentive) and the classification of a for-profit entity receiving tax abatement. Ultimately, members acknowledged the vital community need for child care and noted no direct county revenue loss due to statutory maximum levies.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Mr. Webb voted No on process) [01:50:57](#). *(Note: Advised that this moves to a public hearing and confirming resolution at the April meeting).*
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No members of the public signed up for or spoke during the general open public comment period.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Code of Conduct:** Eugene reported that the draft code of conduct is under committee review and will soon be presented to the full council [01:51:32](#).
 - **Emergency Management & Overtime Warning:** Auditor/Staff warned that public safety departments (EMS, Sheriff, Highway) anticipate future requests for overtime appropriations due to storm disaster responses and upcoming total solar eclipse crowds [01:52:28](#).
 - **Coroner Data:** Coroner Gavin reported autopsies are tracking at 33 year-to-date against a monthly budgeted projection of 11 [01:55:32](#).
 - **Broadband Grant Notice:** Mr. Krantz highlighted the state's Broadband Equity, Access, and Deployment (BEAD) program challenge window (closing June 3, 2024) via connectingindiana.com [01:56:05](#).
 - **Storm Recovery:** Council President Piper provided extensive updates on the cooperative local response to recent tornado and storm damages in Selma, thanking volunteer fire departments, the Highway Department, EMA, and state officials [02:00:32](#).
 - **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn approved by unanimous roll call vote [02:11:10](#). Meeting adjourned to the next regular meeting on **Tuesday, April 23, 2024, at 9:00 A.M.** [02:11:25](#).
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